DOWNTOWN

Sunday
October 11, 2026
THE HINDU

MYLAPORE

Mandaveli » R A Puram » Royapettah » Chindatripet » Royapuram » Korukkupet » Ennore » Luz » Alwarpet » Triplicane » Central

Washermenpet » Tondiarpet » Manali » M.R.C.Nagar » Teynampet » Mount Road » Broadway » Kondithope » Tiruvotiyur



CALLS FOR NEW TRANSFORMERS INTENSIFY

With power demands having increased significantly over the years, many residential areas seek a new transformer to prevent overloading **P5**



PREPARE FOR THE RAINY DAY

George Town is still the place to visit ahead of the monsoon to stock up on rainwear and winterwear **P6**



Common scenes at Park railway station. PHOTOS: RAGU R

Expedite restoration of footbridge at Park Station

Although work on Southern Railway's fourth line project between Chennai Beach and Egmore is over, this elevated pathway is yet to come up

R. RAGU

The foot overbridge at Park Station was dismantled to facilitate Southern Railway's fourth line project between Chennai Beach and Egmore.

Though the project has been completed, the foot overbridge has not been restored. The continued absence of what was an extremely useful facility is keenly felt by commuters. Reportedly, the fabrication of the new footbridge is under way.

Meanwhile, commuters are "paying" for the delay going through the inconvenience of clambering over platforms after crossing the tracks. Needless to say that by crossing the tracks they are putting themselves in harm's way.



The footbridge was particularly helpful to those crossing over from Poonamallee Poonamallee High Road to Chintadripet. These commuters now cross the tracks and navigate a unpaved and uneven pathway accessed through a gate to get to Chintadripet.

Regulars to Park Station point out that two commuters recently had a fall while navigating this pathway at night.

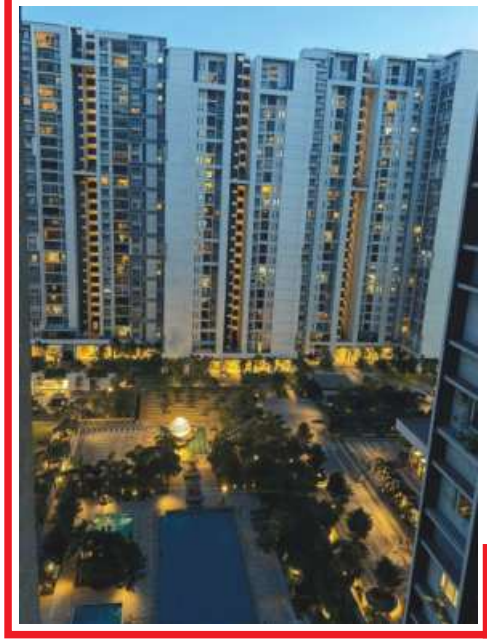




A kind move, but does it really help?

A tree that branched out taking a trajectory that is inconvenient and even dangerous to motorists on Kalvi Varu Street in Mylapore has been "restrained" without causing any harm to it. A Good Samaritan has covered it with a few gunny bags probably to ensure its sharp end does not injure vehicle users. The more practical and effective move would be to lop off the branch. TEXT AND PHOTO: BASKAR SESHADRI

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Regulate parking at Madhava Perumal Temple agraharam

KRISH SRINIVASAN

As a devotee of Madhava Perumal for many years, I am concerned about the spurt in unauthorised parking and misuse of house-front spaces at the agraharam around the Madhava Perumal temple in Mylapore.

With Metro-related traffic diversions, the obstruction has further affected the smooth flow of traffic, including school vans and ambulances (*see picture*).

Such unchecked activity is also giving room for unlawful activities. There have also been instances of crime being reported around M.K. Amman Koil 4th Street , the agraharam's official name.

Agraharams are an important part of our cultural heritage and are fast disappearing, so we need to protect them through better civic management of the areas they are located in.

I request the concerned authorities to take timely measures to regulate parking, improve safety, and preserve this valuable heritage for posterity.

Source segregation demo at RA Puram

Led by Shobana Krishnan and Deepa Raghunath, a new waste management movement will reach out to houses in the locality



At the event.

R. CHANDRASEKARAN

Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) is now in the process of enforcing source segregation of waste, ensuring residents hand over only segregated waste to sanitary workers. Raja Annamalaipuram Residents Association (RAPRA) is keen on having residents in its area segregate waste as per the norms set by GCC.

The regional deputy commissioner of GCC, H.R. Kaushik, had a meeting with the RA Puram residents, in which he stressed upon the importance of segregating waste at origin itself and asked RAPRA to be a role model in this scheme. This advice has motivated RAPRA to guide its residents in the proper way of segregating waste.

In this regard, RAPRA requested Sumeet Elko (formerly Urbaser Sumeet) to educate and guide the residents on how to segregate the waste as per norms put down by GCC. Sumeet Elko gladly accepted this request and deputed their Information Education and Communication (IEC) team to demonstrate the entire process to the residents.

Consequently, on October 4, 2026 Sumeet Elko's IEC Manager Vignesh along with his team made a detailed demonstration to the residents. Despite the event being held on a Sunday afternoon, residents evinced keen interest in it and gathered in good numbers (more than 50 residents attended including children who registered for this demo) to watch and learn from the demonstration. Without using jargons, the IEC team explained the process in detail and described the environmental importance of segregating waste. They said wet waste such as vegetables, food and such other waste should go into green bins, dry waste like paper, cartons, plastics and wrappers should go into blue bins, sanitary waste into red bins and hazardous waste like broken glasses, bulbs and batteries into black bins.

Without using jargons, the IEC team explained the process in detail and described the environmental importance of segregating waste

Residents asked for many clarifications and many requested the team to come again for another demonstration this one for their domestic help who do the job of cleaning the homes and depositing the waste in the bins. The IEC team has promised to conduct another demo.

Two women executive members of RAPRA, Shobana Krishnan and Deepa Raghunath, would spearhead the movement with more than 1000 houses in the area. They are bubbling with energy and would visit each and every building on a daily basis to propagate this scheme and instil in the minds of residents the idea that their garbage is their responsibility.

Calls for new transformers intensify

LIFFY THOMAS

For Bilkhis Sait, "overload", "changeover" and "low voltage" are everyday terminology. A resident of Marshalls Road in Egmore for the last three decades, Bilkhis notes unscheduled power cuts have become a daily feature in her locality.

"Sometimes, the outage lasts a few hours. At times power goes off in all the three phases," says Bilkhis.

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDCL) technicians do attend to complaints raised through the helpline number. "They replace the cable and power is restored but the same issue resurfaces. We have not got a long-term solution," says the French language trainer who wants the transformer in the neighbourhood upgraded.

Residents of Tarapore Avenue in Harrington Road find themselves dealing with the same issue. And they seek the same solution: replacement of the existing transformer. Their latest representation is a little over a month old. For now, the department has provided thicker wires so the frequent power outages have almost reduced.

With independent houses giving way to apartment complexes and commercial buildings in many areas, the rusty transformer is not able to take the load anymore. Increasing power demands from houses and offices using heavy electrical appliances, and climate change are adding to the stress on the neighbourhood distribution transformers.

So, how is TNPDCL addressing the increasing electricity demand and growing renewable energy penetration?

Upgrading the load capacity of an existing transformer, adding new transformers and bifurcating the load supply are some common measures initiated by the electricity department, taken after many assessments and calculations.

In Chennai's residential areas, distribution transformers generally have a load capacity of 100 kVA, 250 kVA and 500 kVA, depending on the number of people the utility is catering to. But rising load is one of the major reasons for transformers failing.

Excess load?

According to officials, transformers have an average lifespan of 20 years but this could vary depending on how well they are maintained. Factors such as natural calamities, manufacturing defects, ageing, short circuits and other unexpected reasons would require these electrical equipments to be replaced more often. Many defunct transformers have to be replaced because of overload and lighting.

TNPDCL is expected to assess areas where complaints are common and initiate improvement measures. A consumer may not know the capacity of the transformer or the distribution network, so the executive engineer for the area should be first informed about such power-related complaints. The engineer has to justify the electricity needs and suggest whether it can do with an upgrade or a new utility transformer is required.

"As the load pattern is different in the morning and evening, the transformer load is measured by our field staff based on a set of parameters. When the transformer reaches more than 80% load then we decide on an upgrade or a new set up, which is done through a measuring tool. Electricity feeders are also remotely monitored by the control centre," says a senior engineer.

TNPDCL field staff prepares and submits an estimate of areas needing a new transformer, almost every month, to submit it to the head office for approval. The time to process a tender is usually three to four months.

Getting ROW clearance

A senior official says one of the biggest hurdles they face is getting right of way (ROW) clearance or permission to instal an electricity transformer in an area.

"Nobody wants a transformer in front of their house or the stay resting on their premises, so this delays the process. We scout for a public space as maintenance work can be taken up easily at such spots," says the official.

The Superintendent Engineer has the power to sanction a transformer. "If a transformer is badly needed in an area then in two-three months time it is sanctioned," says the official.

The "citizen charter" also insists that if the work involves placing or shifting a transformer structure then 90 days is the timeline followed as per the standards of performance for electricity distribution.

Help at hand

Raise a complaint on Minnagam (9498794987) mentioning the frequency of power cuts or other load-related complaints

Write to the respective distribution region in your area seeking a review of the power load. Their contact numbers and mail IDs are on the website https://www.tnpdcl.org/en/tnpdcl/ reach-us/contact-information



With power demands having increased significantly over the years, many residential areas seek a new transformer to prevent overloading

Adopt a holistic approach

Meeting the growing electricity demand of households requires more than just upgrading distribution transformers. Distribution companies (DISCOMs) that supply electricity to consumers in a state need to adopt a holistic approach that combines demand-side management, energy efficiency, timely infrastructure augmentation, and better asset management.

Here are suggestions by Rishu Garg, senior policy specialist working in the Energy and Power sector at CSTEP.

Demand-response programmes: DISCOMs can encourage households to shift flexible electricity consumption, such as operating washing machines and water heaters, away from peak-demand hours through suitable incentives. This can help flatten peak demand, ease pressure on local distribution networks, and defer the need for some infrastructure upgrades.

Promote energy-efficient appliances: wider adoption of energy-efficient air conditioners, refrigerators, water heaters, and other household appliances can reduce overall electricity consumption and limit the growth of peak demand. Targeted incentives, consumer awareness, and easier access to efficient appliances can help accelerate adoption.

Strengthen distribution infrastructure and expedite transformer upgrades: DISCOMs should make effective use of schemes such as the Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS) to augment distribution infrastructure in areas experiencing rapid growth in household demand. Equally important are streamlined approval processes, clear timelines, and proactive identification of overloaded distribution transformers to ensure that capacity upgrades are completed before they become critical. However, this should be done after conducting feasibility studies based on load growth.

Adopt distribution asset lifecycle management systems: DISCOMs should invest in digital systems to monitor transformer loading, asset health, maintenance requirements, and failure risks.

Prepare for the rainy day

The wholesalers and retailers in this specific trade might be scattered, but George Town is still the place to visit ahead of the monsoon to stock up on rainwear and winterwear. Two legacy enterprises illustrate why this is Chennai's rainwear hub

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

In George Town, trades have a vice-like grip on streets, owning them to the point of suffocation. Every street name board bears an unwritten promise to meet an overwhelming existential need. If bags are your ticket to retail therapy, head to Stringer Street. Seeking to announce a new life chapter with the printing of a wedding card? Anderson Street holds out an invitation to you to visit it. Want to indulge your sartorial addiction? Saunter into Godown Street. Looking to be stocked up on rainwear ahead of the monsoon? No pat answer there; that requires the directory of George Town to be consulted.

Rainwear shopping in George Town is spatially undefined, but George Town is the best place in town to scour for it. Wholesalers and retailers of raincoats and umbrellas and woollen winterwear (you read that right, exclusive winter wear shopping in Chennai) are scattered across the landscape. They are found on NSC Bose Road, separated by shops ruled by other trades; on Malayaperumal Street and Rattan Bazaar Road. The term "raingear" presupposes seasonality; and the enterprises, both wholesale and retail, pair them with an all-season product or two to keep the cash register ringing through the year.

On Malayaperumal Street, New Jothi Stores LLP does this kind of pairing to stay afloat on a non-rainy day. The product line reads: bags, luggages, raincoats and umbrellas. The enterprise was established in 1968 by Hajji Jamal Mohideen, who handed over the baton to his sons, Hajji Ajmal Khan and Hajji Mujibur Rahman. And the baton is now lodged with the founder's grandsons, Muhammed Mohideen and his cousin Muhammed Sirajudeen. The store at George Town boasts massive square-footage, and is present in other locations, not as outlets but manufacturing units. There is a unit in Mint Street, another in Athipet and two others in Maharashtra, each one dedicated to the manufacture of specific product. In addition, there is sourcing from elsewhere which includes importing. The shelves at New Jothi Stores offer a glimpse of what happens when necessity meets a little imagination. From traditional umbrellas to reversible ones, torchlight umbrellas and designs that change colour when wet, the shop's promise of variety takes centre stage. While the bags and luggages segment is on an even keel through the year, the one involving raincoats and umbrellas wax and wane depending on the monsoon and its intensity. Copious rains means brisk business. But New Jothi Stores does not chase only the North East Monsoon for business, but the South West Monsoon as well. As a wholesaler, its brings Kerala and Karnataka into the picture supplying raincoats and umbrellas to retailers out there, and what emerges is a semblance of an all-year business.

Besides, with a touch of creativity and customisation, a seasonal project such as the umbrella is made attractive when the skies are clear. Mohideen points out that umbrellas made in the colours of a political party are a hit through the year. So, there are umbrellas that cover all parties on the political spectrum, enabling party cadres to display their allegiance.

Shopping spots

Streets close to Flower Bazaar sport shops selling monsoon kit, NSC Bose Road has a number of them including Ebrahim Currim & Sons, the iconic manufatiurer and seller of Stag umbrellas. There is MS Rahim Stores for raincoats. On Malayaperumal Street, there is New Jothi Stores. On Mangammal Street, there is Hindustan Industries. On Rattan Bazaar Road, there is Joonus Sait & Sons.

Where 'winter' never ends

All through the year, winter hovers over one address at Ratan Bazaar Road in George Town. Joonus Sait & Sons, established in 1905, sells rainwear and woollen winterwear in good old, often searing-hot Chennai, operating in bustling Ratan Bazaar. The patriarch of the family, Usman Sait defends the decision taken by his forbear several "winters" ago and followed by successive generations. The winterwear is not just for those navigating a narrow band of winter months in Chennai, but also for those travelling abroad to coordinates where winter defines the climate more than any other season. In a globalised economy, a massive number of people go abroad for studies and work and vacations (and of course, there are also cooler places in India to travel to), remarks Usman, and they know "there is a Joonus Sait & Sons". That confidence bordering on chutzpah has worked for the family and the business, which has put out branches, one in Purasaiwalkam and another in Adyar. Usman manages the legacy enterprise with the support of his wife Zulekha and sons Naumaan Sait and Safwaan Sait.

The enterprise's service extends to helping customers choose according to their destination and travel duration and also educating them on preserving the items. Bulk order for corporate clients is a strong feature of the business. Its woollen wear, including brands such as Monte Carlo, are sourced from Ludhiana. For Usman, the store is also a childhood memory. He recalls accompanying his father after school, wondering why he had to spend the afternoon there. The lessons he absorbed however became his own principles, passed down to his sons. Legacy is the operative word. Usman speaks wistfully of the golden days when his father was his mentor in the trade. He speaks with equal fondness of the here and now, with a special softness reserved for his four granddaughters, who visit the store and learn the business from him. He adds that they will take the legacy forward. Usman's son Naumaan notes that the enterprise treats every client as a part of the legacy.



A Sunday of cars, clues and community

MRC Nagar came alive over the weekend with a unique neighbourhood car rally that brought families together for a Sunday of driving, quizzing and treasure hunting.

Organised with the support of the MRC Nagar Residents Association and Ceebros 174, the rally transformed the neighbourhood into an interactive trail, with participating families navigating familiar streets, solving clues and discovering lesser-known facets of MRC Nagar.

Conceived, directed and managed by Shoba Ravishankar, the event featured a specially curated quiz on the neighbourhood, covering its history, landmarks and interesting local trivia. The quiz drew enthusiastic participation, with residents keen on testing their knowledge of their own neighbourhood, said a press release.

Adding to the experience was a lunch and high tea sponsored by Broken Bridge Café by Radio Room, along with ice creams from Arun Icecreams and takeaway desserts from Muffinbox.

Lanson Toyota and Zimson Watches were the principal sponsors of the event, while Toyota Vellfire, Toyota Camry and Toyota Hilux added an automotive highlight to the day's proceedings, added the release.

MMA honours Asian Games medallist Vithya Ramraj

The Madras Management Association (MMA), in association with TimeLinks and Konrad-Adenauer-Stiftung, organised a special programme titled "Beyond the Hurdles – The Champion's Mindset for Leadership Excellence" at the MMA Management Center on Pathari Road in Thousand Lights, celebrating the outstanding achievements of Indian Olympian and Asian Games medallist Vithya Ramraj.

The highlight of the evening was an engaging conversation between Vithya Ramraj and Indian table tennis legend and Padma Shri awardee Achanta Sharath Kamal, who explored the mindset, discipline and resilience behind sustained excellence in competitive sport. The programme sought to draw meaningful parallels between sporting excellence and leadership in business and management, says a press release.

At the recently concluded Asian Games in Nagoya, Vithya created history by clocking 54.75 seconds in the women's 400m hurdles, setting a new Indian national record and surpassing the iconic benchmark established by P. T. Usha at the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics. She also won gold in the women's 4×400m relay, silver in the mixed 4×400m relay and bronze in the 400m hurdles.



CM launches 'Dream Olympics'

Ishari K. Ganesh, president, Tamil Nadu Olympic Association, and founder-chancellor, Vels University, welcomed C. Joseph Vijay, Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, at The Leela Palace recently.

The CM launched the 'Dream Olympics' initiative and felicitated Tamil Nadu's Asian Games and chess olympiad medal winners at the event organised by Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu (SDAT).

Aadhav Arjuna, State Minister for Sports Development, and prominent sportspersons were among those who took part in the event.



Kalaa Manjari completes 17 years



Kalaa Manjari Centre of Creativity has completed 17 years, marking a journey that began in 2009 with a vision to provide children with meaningful learning opportunities beyond academics.

Kalaa Manjari focuses on skill-based learning for children aged 5 years and above, supporting their overall development through activities that encourage focus, attention, confidence, creativity, discipline, communication and social skills. The centre also aims to provide constructive alternatives to excessive screen time and help children develop the confidence to interact with peers and face competition positively.

The centre offers a diverse range of programmes including Chess, Karate, Phonetics, Handwriting, Hindi, Tamil, All-Subject Tuitions, Carnatic Vocal and Shloka.

Two new programmes – Environmental Education and Adult Classes – are being launched from Vijayadasami, said a release.

One can avail a special offer on registration for all classes offered at Kalaa Manjari this Vijayadasami.

For enquiries & registrations: 98402 25570 / 91766 10660

Kalaa Manjari Center of Creativity is located on 25/13, 2nd Street, East Abhiramapuram.

Charging station in Poonamallee

Zappang Charging Stations has opened an electric vehicle (EV) charging station at Motel Highway in Poonamallee.

The station features a 60 kW DC fast-charging facility, designed to provide convenient charging for EV users. Focused on clean energy and sustainable transportation, Zappang aims to make EV charging more accessible for motorists. The facility promotes a greener driving experience and encourages the transition towards environmentally friendly mobility solutions.

For location details and inquiries, contact 95666 83952.



Impressive performance by Saveetha college students in sports meet

Saveetha Dental College Sports Club participated in ALTIUS'26, an inter-collegiate medical and dental sports meet, organised by Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education & Research in Porur recently.

According to a press release, Saveetha Dental College team delivered an impressive performance. students won silver, gold, and bronze in the long jump. The college also won the volleyball tournament, adds the release.

In cricket, a student of the college won the "best bowler" title.

The kho kho team of Saveetha Dental College Sports Club securing the runner-up place in De Sportivous 4.0, another inter-college sports event, organized by Saveetha College of Occupational Therapy, held recently at Saveetha Medical College, Thandalam.

The teams were appreciated by the chancellor of Saveetha University, Dr. N. M Veeraiyan, adds the press release.



An intergenerational initiative

Marking the International Day of Older Persons, Geri Care organised Across the Table, an intergenerational initiative that brought senior citizens and young volunteers together for one-on-one conversations at Kaylir Canteen, Mylapore. By pairing participants (elderly and the young) who had never met before, the event created an opportunity for stories, experiences and perspectives to be exchanged across generations, leading to new friendships, deeper understanding and connections that extended beyond the evening itself.

The activity began with icebreakers, games around Chennai's history and cinema, along with delicious South Indian specialities.

In a release, Anand Subramanian, Chief Marketing and Communications Officer, Geri Care, said "Across the Table was built on a simple belief that meaningful human connections are essential to healthy ageing."

Challani Jewellery exhibition open today at Taj Connemara

Challani Jewellery Mart's Challani's Jewelverse –Season 1, a grand showcase of exquisite jewellery, commenced on October 9 at Taj Connemara, under the leadership of Jayanthilal Challani, founder and chairman of Challani Jewellery Mart.



The exhibition was inaugurated by Adityaram, founder and chairman of the Adityaram Group who formally opened the event by cutting the ribbon and lighting the traditional ceremonial lamp.

According to a press release, the exhibition brings together an extensive collection of fine jewellery, featuring gold, diamonds, Polki, rose-cut diamonds and coloured gemstones under one roof.

Combining traditional craftsmanship with contemporary designs, the showcase offers visitors an opportunity to explore a diverse range of distinctive jewellery collections.

Speaking to the media after the inauguration, Adityaram expressed his appreciation for the collection on display. "I have visited several jewellery exhibitions, but the variety of collections showcased here is truly remarkable. What stands out is the range of designs available not only for women but also for men, with distinctive pieces that are visually appealing," he said.

Jayanthilal Challani said although Challani Jewellery Mart has several branches, our objective is to bring different categories of jewellery together in one place, offering customers a comprehensive shopping experience. This exhibition features an exclusive selection of gold, diamond, Polki, rose-cut and coloured gemstone jewellery.

The inaugural event witnessed the participation of several prominent personalities, including Thangamalar Jagannath and Dr. Vimala Rani Britto. Visitors were seen exploring the collections with considerable interest.

Challani's Jewelverse - Season 1 is being held from October 9 to 11 (between 10:00 a.m. and 9:00 p.m.)

Venue: Taj Connemara, Binny Road, Near Spencer Plaza



Property expo in Pallavaram

Today is the final day of ARK Eventz Property Expo 2026. The event is being held at Arul Murugan Towers, 200 Feet Radial Road, Old Pallavaram, and at Swapna Thirumana Mandapam, GST Road, Urapakkam; 10 a.m. to 7 p.m.

At the expo, prospective buyers can explore a wide range of property options, including apartments, villas, plots, and investment opportunities. Buyers can meet builders and developers, compare properties, and discover attractive options, said a release.

For registration and details, visit www.arkeventz.com or call 94444 56087.

'Restore the concession for the elderly in trains'

Close to 300 members and office bearers of the Federation of Senior Citizens Associations of Tamil Nadu in Nanganallur held a peaceful demonstration on October 1 (World Elders' Day) demanding the restoration of fare concessions for the elderly on long-distance trains.

Members gathered at Swamy Sivanandha Salai in Chepauk and urged the Central government to restore the concession, which was stopped after COVID-19.



